19.9 Polypharmacy in Older Adults*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I take 11 tablets and I am not sure what each is for." **Objective** • Several prescribers • Duplicate medicines found	**ACTUAL** Ineffective health self-management related to a complex medication regimen as evidenced by confusion about medicines and duplication.	• Understands a simplified regimen.	• Review his medicines with the physician or pharmacist. • Give a written schedule. • Suggest a pill organizer. • Remove expired and duplicate medicines.	• Outcome reached when he understands the regimen.
Subjective • "I feel dizzy in the morning." **Objective** • BP drops on standing • Unsteady when he gets up	**ACTUAL** Decreased activity tolerance related to medication adverse effects as evidenced by dizziness on rising.	• No dizziness on rising within 1 week.	• Report side effects to the prescriber. • Teach him to get up slowly. • Measure lying and standing BP.	• Considered met once the dizziness settles.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Polypharmacy • Reduced kidney function	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: drug interactions and adverse drug effects.	• No adverse drug events.	• Arrange regular medicine reviews. • Ask him to report any new symptoms. • Keep one up-to-date medicine list.	• Goal reached if no adverse events occur.

*References for this care plan: [4], [35], [71], [126]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.